

SOGGY SOIL

Rainforests are home to thousands of plants, but the soil is shallow and poor. Up to 10 metres (400 in) of rain a year washes the nutrients away. Some clever plants live on each other, instead!

Rainforests get ten times as much rain as deserts.

Fig plants wrap around tree trunks.

Strangler Fig

This plant's seeds sprout in the moist, nutrient-rich tree tops. The seedlings grow down to the forest floor and eventually take root in the soil.

Animals eat fig fruits, and their poo spreads the seeds.



Fungi on the roots help the plant absorb nutrients.

Buttress roots

Tall trees have thick buttress roots that grow out from the trunk above ground for stability. Nutrients are near the soil surface, so tree roots are shallow.